

IN TEST: 4 OFFICE SUITES

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Everything Office about it

Office suites undergo version changes and free suites also make their presence felt. Choose the best for your needs

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You know what's common between an office suite and an operating system? Everyone has one installed on his or her computer. The first software that you normally install after the operating system is the office suite—especially the word processor. Even if you are still caught up in the DOS age, you still have your faithful Wordstar. But there's more to an office suite than a word processor. Your spreadsheet is useful in managing a whole lot of your tabular information or even

databases, and you can really impress people with the presentations you create.

The contenders

Among the four office suites for the Windows platform that we tested, Microsoft Office XP doesn't work with Windows 95 now, and if you are planning to use the voice recognition feature, you would need 128 MB RAM. However, it is more feature-rich than the other versions.